

Literature dissection

Spring 2026

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2026-05-20

Table of contents

Photo documentation	1
Table	2
Reports or posters	3
Report or poster information	3
Annotated bibliography	3
Background	3
Directions	4
Paper 1	4
Paper 2	5
Paper 3	5
Paper 4	5
Paper 5	5
Paper 6	6
Paper 7	6
Paper 8	6
Paper 9	6
Paper 10	7
Paper 12	7
References	7

Photo documentation

Individually:

1. Find the document titled “Data Description: Photo Documentation of the North Campus Open Space Restoration Project”.
2. Read about the photo documentation process.
3. Find 1-3 photo points relevant to your study using the ArcGIS web map.

As a group:

4. Discuss which photo point to focus on based on its relevance to your study question or context.
5. Decide on a photo point.
6. Find 2-4 photos at that photo point to represent seasonal changes within a water year.
7. In the table below, fill in the information for each photo at the photo point.

Table

Photo point number	Date of photo	Season	Direction of photo	Link to photo
42	April 2025	Spring	South	here
42	October 2024	Fall	South	here
42	April 2025	Spring	North East	here
42	October 2024	Fall	North East	here
42	April 2025	Spring	South East	here
42	October 2024	Fall	South East	here

8. Describe in 5-7 sentences total:
 - which water year you chose to examine
 - how that water year is relevant to your study
 - which photo point you chose to examine
 - how that photo point is relevant to your study
 - what changes you see in vegetation, animals, environmental characteristics from the photos you chose.

We chose to examine photos from water year 2025, which started on October 1st 2024 and ended on September 30th 2025. Our study is focused on how water elevation’s relationship to bird abundance, specifically in water year 2025, so photos from Fall 2024 and Spring 2025 are most relevant. We selected photo point 42, positioned on the Northern end of NCOS along the West Elings Marsh trail, because its photos capture a broad landscape of the slough’s profile, and water elevation is easily observable from that perspective.

Reports or posters

Individually:

1. Navigate to a. the Posters section or b. the Reports section of the collection.
2. Find the poster(s) or report(s) related to your project.

As a group:

3. Discuss which poster or report to focus on based on its relevance to your study question or context. **Note that you only need one of either type.**
4. Read the poster or report.
5. Discuss the key insights.
6. Provide the information in the space below. For “Key insights” and “Relevance to your study”, respond in 3-5 sentences.

Report or poster information

Title:

Authors:

Year published:

Permalink:

Dataset used (likely):

Key insights:

Relevance to your study (be specific here with the question you have asked, the figures you’ve made, the insights you’ve gained, etc.):

Annotated bibliography

Background

You can find peer-reviewed articles by searching on Google Scholar, which is a large database of research papers, posters, and other materials.

Note: while it may be tempting to use AI to provide a list of papers for you, you should *not* be using AI for any component of this activity. You’ll accomplish the objective of articulating the connection between your study and other study systems/questions by completing the difficult task of sifting through papers that may not be relevant to you before finding one that is.

Additionally, you can test out inserting citations in Quarto. See [this resource to insert a citation in a .qmd](#).

Directions

Individually:

1. Search Google Scholar for papers that might be relevant to your study. One recommendation for how to start: search for whatever your focal variables may be + “wetland restoration” (for example, “bird abundance wetland restoration”, “water salinity wetland restoration”, “aquatic invertebrate wetland restoration”).
2. Find 4-5 papers that might be relevant based on title and what shows up in the search.
3. Read the abstracts of those 4-5 papers.
4. Decide which - if any - are actually relevant to your project. Make a note of these papers. Note that a paper may be relevant in that it shares a) taxonomic groups, b) geographic regions, c) research questions, d) research methodology - there are lots of ways that existing research can be tied into your project.
5. If step 4 did not yield any relevant papers, repeat steps 2-4.
6. Search for papers until you have 4 relevant papers per person (12 total for a 3 person group).

As a group:

7. Share the papers you found, discussing the main points of the paper and how they are relevant to your project.
8. Fill in the template for an annotated bibliography below.
9. In the “Main findings” or “Relevance to study” sections, insert a citation for the paper.

Paper 1

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 2

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 3

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 4

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 5

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 6

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 7

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 8

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 9

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 10

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

Paper 12

Title:

Authors:

Main findings (2-4 sentences):

Relevance to study (2-4 sentences):

References